

Aaron Gogna

New York and Toronto – Location Flexible

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Summary

Fintech strategy and growth leader with 14 years of experience defining company-level strategy, identifying high-impact growth opportunities, and translating ambiguous business problems into actionable initiatives that drive durable growth. Deep experience across consumer fintech, financial services, payments, digital banking, product strategy, pricing, monetization, customer experience, and growth operations.

Currently Director of Strategy and Transformation at Apply Digital, where I lead strategic growth, AI, digital product, and revenue initiatives for Fortune 500 and high-growth clients across financial services, fintech, technology, retail, and consumer platforms. Previously spent nearly a decade at Simon-Kucher, the global leader in pricing, monetization, and commercial growth strategy, advising major financial institutions, fintechs, and technology companies on growth strategy, product strategy, market opportunities, competitive positioning, financial modeling, and executive decision-making.

Embedded for six years with Qapital, a 2M+ consumer fintech platform and a direct Chime competitor, partnering directly with the co-CEOs and leadership team to shape product strategy, growth strategy, pricing, monetization, customer experience, lifecycle engagement, and business performance management. Helped scale the platform across saving, spending, checking, debit, investing, budgeting, and subscription products, building the strategic, analytical, and operational systems behind 28% conversion, 98%+ monthly retention post-onboarding, 12.6x LTV/CAC, 82%+ contribution margins, and \$2.8B in deposits.

Relevant Experience

Apply Digital

Director, Strategy, Transformation & Growth

2024 – Present

Toronto, ON, Canada

Apply Digital is a high-growth product, experience, technology, and AI consultancy with 700+ employees, partnering with Fortune 500 and high-growth organizations to define long-term growth strategy, identify new market and product opportunities, build digital platforms, modernize customer experiences, and translate strategy into measurable business outcomes.

- Led end-to-end digital transformation and growth programs in high-ambiguity environments, taking strategic initiatives from ideation and hypothesis development through validation, concepting, design, build, pilot deployment, and scaling, while concurrently driving the people, process, and technology changes required to operationalize solutions and deliver measurable business impact.
- Built and scaled a net-new monetization practice from zero inside Apply Digital, identifying the market opportunity, developing proprietary analytical methodologies and growth frameworks, and executing end to end to drive \$1M+ in revenue impact within the first 6 months.

- Shaped enterprise AI strategy and growth implementation, deploying AI-powered solutions that drive measurable business outcomes. Example: partnered with Kraft Heinz to define and launch TasteMaker, an AI platform now used by 1,200+ users across marketing, design, R&D, and innovation, compressing concept-to-market timelines from 8 weeks to 8 days and unlocking \$37M in value YTD in 2025.
- Analyzed market, competitor, and consumer trends to inform strategy and growth priorities, developing deep analytical insights and data-driven recommendations that supported decision-making and prioritization for Fortune 500 and high-growth clients.
- Built and owned complex financial models and analytical frameworks incorporating cohort economics, scenario simulations, revenue forecasting, elasticity analyses, and margin sensitivity, producing the quantitative foundation for executive growth and investment decisions.
- Influenced decisions and drove collaboration across Product, Marketing, Analytics, and Finance, partnering with C-suite executives to translate growth strategies into actionable plans with clear milestones and performance tracking systems that connected strategic priorities to operational execution.
- Communicated strategic findings and growth recommendations to senior leadership, building executive buy-in and driving alignment through clear, insight-driven narratives that moved decisions at Fortune 500 and PE-backed clients.

Simon-Kucher

Director, Financial Services and Head of Customer Experience Practice, Canada

2015 – 2024

New York, NY, USA

Simon-Kucher is a global management consultancy with 2,000+ employees and a leading authority on pricing, monetization, revenue growth, customer experience, and commercial transformation for enterprise technology, financial services, fintech, retail, and B2B organizations.

- Led high-impact growth transformations across the North American financial services, fintech, and technology practices, focused on pricing and packaging strategy, revenue model redesign, sales strategy and operations, customer experience transformation, product adoption, and commercial growth, serving as a trusted advisor to CTOs, CMOs, CPOs, and CFOs.
- Served as Head of Customer Experience for North America, leading end-to-end redesign of digital customer ecosystems for Fortune 500s and unicorn startups across financial services and fintech, spanning first-touch acquisition through product discovery, value propositions, cross-sell mechanics, checkout flows, lifecycle engagement, and long-term retention journeys.
- Built the North American Customer Experience practice from zero to a \$5M+ P&L, ten-person team, and six consecutive quarters of double-digit growth, establishing the delivery methodologies, intellectual property, quality standards, and hiring bar the practice runs on today.
- Applied behavioral economics and consumer research to develop deep insights into how everyday consumers make financial decisions, translating those insights into growth strategies and product recommendations that changed behavior at scale. Example: designed an onboarding experience for a major Canadian financial institution using choice architecture and the Zeigarnik effect, lifting products-per-customer by 200%+ in pilot cohorts.
- Analyzed market, competitor, and consumer trends to inform company strategy and growth priorities, synthesizing multiple signals into clear, defensible strategic recommendations. Example: led the complete growth strategy and market entry analysis for a global payments company's new product rollout, sizing the market opportunity, identifying competitive whitespace, and developing the strategic rationale that drove executive go/no-go decisions across markets.

- Built and owned complex financial models incorporating market sizing, elasticity analyses, cohort economics, scenario simulations, revenue waterfall modeling, and margin sensitivity, producing the data-driven analytical foundation for executive strategic decisions on initiatives with hundreds of millions in revenue at stake.
- Built the executive narratives, business cases, and strategic presentations that translated market analysis, consumer insight, and commercial complexity into boardroom-ready recommendations, influencing multi-year growth and investment decisions at the CTO, CMO, CPO, and CFO level.
- Led project teams end to end on the highest-priority and most ambiguous strategic problems, driving cross-functional alignment across Product, Marketing, Analytics, and Finance while holding teams accountable to deliver measurable business outcomes.

Qapital

Embedded Strategy and Growth Leader

2016 – 2022

New York, NY, USA

Qapital is a B2C fintech, direct Chime competitor, and Simon-Kucher client serving 2M+ users, known for applying behavioral economics to automate financial habits across saving, budgeting, investing, and debt management.

- Embedded as the strategic growth partner to Qapital's co-CEOs over six years, identifying where the business should go next, shaping long-term vision with senior leadership, and translating strategy into actionable growth initiatives that drove the platform from early-stage fintech to a 2M+ user, \$2.8B-deposit business recognized as Google Play's "Most Innovative App" and Apple's "Best App for Savings."
- Led end-to-end digital growth transformation across the full customer lifecycle, owning strategy and execution from first-touch acquisition through product discovery, onboarding, activation, cross-sell mechanics, lifecycle engagement, and long-term retention, ensuring every stage of the funnel compounded into durable member growth.
- Analyzed consumer, market, and competitor trends to inform company strategy and growth priorities, developing deep analytical insights into how everyday Americans make financial decisions and translating those insights into growth strategies and product recommendations that drove durable acquisition, activation, engagement, and retention at consumer fintech scale.
- Built and owned complex financial models and analytical frameworks incorporating market sizing, cohort economics, elasticity analyses, scenario simulations, revenue forecasting, and margin sensitivity, using rigorous data-driven decision-making to prioritize the highest-impact growth initiatives and guide executive investment decisions in real time.
- Designed and owned the pricing, packaging, and subscription economics that underpinned Qapital's commercial growth engine, architecting three-tier subscription tiers, feature gating, value proposition mapping, upgrade mechanics, and retention systems that delivered 82%+ contribution margins, 12.6x LTV/CAC, 10-month payback, and a trajectory to projected \$238M in annual subscription revenue.
- Combined behavioral economics expertise and primary consumer research to translate willingness-to-pay thresholds, choice architecture, anchoring effects, loss aversion structures, and commitment devices into growth strategies, onboarding architectures, and lifecycle engagement systems that changed everyday consumer financial behavior at scale, driving a 28% conversion rate and 4M+ goals created.

- Drove cross-functional growth execution without direct authority, influencing and aligning Product, Marketing, Analytics, Finance, and Operations on strategic priorities, holding the full organization accountable to growth targets, and ensuring strategy translated into real execution with measurable outcomes quarter over quarter.
- Personally built the executive narratives, growth business cases, and investment recommendations that shaped Qapital's multi-year strategic direction, communicating complex analytical findings and consumer insights to senior leadership in clear, decision-ready formats that drove alignment and action.
- Delivered durable growth outcomes that rival the best consumer fintech businesses in the world: 2M+ users, \$2.8B in deposits, 98%+ monthly retention post-onboarding, 70% one-year retention at nearly 2x the industry average, 93rd-percentile NPS of 57 versus 32 industry average, 4.8-star App Store rating across 80K+ reviews, and a projected \$238M subscription revenue run rate, demonstrating the ability to turn strategic vision into compounding, defensible business outcomes at consumer scale.

University of Toronto

Research Lead, Behavioral Economics

2012 – 2015

Toronto, ON, Canada

- Conducted quantitative and qualitative research on consumer behavior, decision-making, behavioral economics, incentives, and choice architecture, building the foundation for later work in executive transformation, adoption design, customer experience, and AI-enabled behavior change.
- Translated complex behavioral data into structured insights, analytical models, research narratives, and presentations for senior academic stakeholders.
- Developed rigorous understanding of how people adopt new behaviors, respond to incentives, navigate tradeoffs, and make decisions under uncertainty - expertise later applied to enterprise transformation, product adoption, executive enablement, and embedded experience design.

Select Client Experience

Select client and industry experience includes consumer fintech, digital banking, payments, financial services, technology platforms, consumer apps, retail, CPG, and high-growth digital businesses. Relevant work spans company strategy, growth strategy, product strategy, monetization, pricing, market research, competitor analysis, customer segmentation, product analytics, financial modeling, business case development, and cross-functional execution for organizations including Qapital, Mastercard, CIBC, Scotiabank, TD Bank, RBC, BMO, Capital One, Chase, ADP, Allstate, Finastra, Kraft Heinz, NBA, Canadian Tire, Lululemon, Arc'teryx, Cloudflare, and 30+ additional Fortune 500 and high-growth clients.